National Insurance and Social Security (NIS) — Barbados

NIS Life Certificate

Form Specification | Service Pattern Analysis | Old Age / Survivors' / Disablement Benefit — Proof of Life Declaration

> ⚑ *DUAL-ROLE FORM NOTICE: This form has TWO distinct user roles. SECTION A is completed by the CLAIMANT (personal details + signature/mark). SECTION B is completed by an AUTHORISED WITNESS (not a family member) who certifies the claimant was alive on the date of signing. The digital service must support both roles within a single submission flow. Additionally, Section A includes a CONDITIONAL sub-form for spouses receiving Survivors'/Death Benefit, capturing remarriage or cohabitation status. This is a periodic renewal form — required every six months in June and December.*

Form Metadata

Form Name	NIS Life Certificate
Form Code	LC-NIS-01 (no official code on paper form)
MDA	National Insurance and Social Security Office (NIS), Barbados
Legal Basis	National Insurance and Social Security Act, Cap. 47 — Old Age Contributory Pension, Survivors'/Death Benefit, and Disablement Benefit provisions
Purpose	Establishes that a benefit recipient (pensioner or beneficiary) is alive on the date of the declaration. Required every six months — June and December — for all recipients of Old Age Contributory Pension, Survivors'/Death Benefit, and Disablement Benefit. Failure to submit may result in delayed or suspended payments.
Completed By	TWO ROLES: (1) CLAIMANT — completes personal details, signs or marks the form; (2) AUTHORISED WITNESS — certifies the claimant's identity and confirms they were alive on the date of signing. The witness must NOT be a family member.
Applies To	All recipients of: Old Age Contributory Pension | Survivors'/Death Benefit | Disablement Benefit
Frequency	Bi-annual — must be submitted in June and December each year
Complexity	Easy
Estimated Time	~10 minutes (claimant + witness sections combined)
Total Fields	~22 fields across 2 sections plus a declaration
Flow Type	Single-page paper form — to be digitised as a Two-Phase Multi-Step flow: (1) Claimant self-service phase; (2) Witness certification phase
Date Analyzed	April 2026
Analyzed By	GovTech Barbados

Service Pattern Pages: Applicability Check

ℹ *Because this is a periodic renewal form with two distinct roles (claimant + witness), the Start Page must be split or versioned accordingly. The Criteria & Entitlement page is used only for the Survivors' Benefit conditional sub-form (remarriage/cohabitation check).*

	Page	Notes
☑	**1. Start Page**	*REQUIRED — Two versions needed: (a) Claimant-facing: explains what the Life Certificate is, who needs it, and when; (b) Witness-facing: explains the witness's legal responsibility and acceptable witness categories*
☒	**2. Eligibility Page**	*NOT APPLICABLE — Eligibility for the benefit is already established; this form only confirms continued survival*
☑	**3. Applicant Details Page**	*REQUIRED — Section A (Personal Details): name, address, NIN/NRN, contact info — standard blocks, pre-populated from NIS records where possible*
☑	**4. Criteria & Entitlement Page**	*CONDITIONAL — Only for Survivors'/Death Benefit recipients: captures whether the claimant has remarried or cohabitated, and if so, the date. Determines continued entitlement.*
☒	**5. Evidence-Based Questions Page**	*NOT APPLICABLE — No detailed evidence questions; the conditional remarriage/cohabitation date is captured on the Criteria page*
☒	**6. External Evidence Upload Page**	*NOT APPLICABLE — No document uploads required by the form; witness certification is the evidence mechanism*
☑	**7. Check Your Answers Page**	*REQUIRED — Claimant reviews before witness counter-signs; both sections should be visible for review*
☑	**8. Payment & Submit Page**	*No Payment version — Declaration + claimant signature/mark + witness certification*
☑	**9. Confirmation & Next Steps Page**	*REQUIRED — Confirms submission to NIS and advises on the next due date (6 months hence)*

PAGE 1 — START PAGE (Two Versions: Claimant-Facing + Witness-Facing)

Purpose: Sets expectations for the claimant and separately for the authorised witness. Explains the legal requirement, who is eligible to witness, and what is needed before starting. REQUIRED for all forms.

Claimant-Facing Start Page

Element	Content / Guidance	Example
Form Title (H1)	*Form name as H1*	Submit Your NIS Life Certificate
Last Updated	*Standard last updated date*	Last updated on April 1st, 2026
Service Description	*Who needs this and why*	Use this service to confirm to the National Insurance Office that you are still alive and eligible to continue receiving your benefit. You must submit this certificate every six months — in June and December.
Who needs to do this	*Benefit types that require this form*	You must complete this Life Certificate if you receive any of the following NIS benefits: Old Age Contributory Pension | Survivors'/Death Benefit | Disablement Benefit
Failure Warning	*Consequence of non-submission*	Failure to submit your Life Certificate by the due date may result in a delay or suspension of your benefit payments.
Complete in One Go Notice	*Standard notice*	You should complete your application in one go. It is not possible to save and return later.
How long does it take?	*Estimated time*	It should take no longer than 10 minutes, including time for your authorised witness to certify the form.
What you will need	*Bullet list*	• Your National Insurance Number and National Registration Number• A valid form of ID (Passport, Driver's Licence, or National ID Card)• An authorised witness (Magistrate, Justice of the Peace, Medical Practitioner, Attorney-at-Law, Bank Manager, Member of Parliament, Senior Civil Servant, Gazetted Police Officer, or Senior NIS Officer)• Note: Your witness must NOT be a family member
What happens after?	*Next steps*	NIS will record your Life Certificate and your benefit payments will continue. You will be notified of your next due date.
Start Button	*Green primary button*	Start now

Witness-Facing Start Page

> ℹ *The witness accesses their section via a secure link sent to the claimant, or via a separate witness entry point on the digital service. The witness start page must clearly explain their legal obligation.*

Element	Content
Form Title (H1)	Certify a Life Certificate for NIS
Who can complete this	You can certify this Life Certificate if you are one of the following:For Barbados residents: Magistrate, Justice of the Peace, Medical Practitioner, Attorney-at-Law, Bank Manager, Member of Parliament, Senior Civil Servant, Gazetted Police Officer, Senior NIS OfficerFor overseas beneficiaries: Member of the Barbados Mission, Notary Public, Bank Official, Medical Practitioner
Who CANNOT complete this	You must NOT certify this form if you are a family member of the claimant.
What you will need	• The claimant's valid ID (Passport, Driver's Licence, or National ID Card)• The date on which you witnessed the claimant alive• Your full name, profession, and signature
Legal Warning	Any person who knowingly certifies a false declaration for the purpose of obtaining an NIS benefit commits an offence punishable by fine, imprisonment, or both.

PAGE 2 — APPLICANT / CLAIMANT DETAILS (Paper Form: Section A — Personal Details)

ℹ *Section A maps to the standard Name Block, Personal Details Block, Address Block, and Contact Block from the NIS form series. In the digital service, fields should be pre-populated from the NIS benefit record to reduce data entry burden for older or disabled claimants. The claimant confirms rather than re-enters their details.*

Official Use Block (Paper Form Header)

⚠ *The paper form carries a 'For Official Use' header row collecting National Insurance No. and National Registration No. In the digital service, these must be auto-populated from the NIS benefit record — not entered manually by the claimant.*

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
National Insurance No.	Text Input (read-only)	Label: "National Insurance Number"Help: "Auto-populated from your NIS benefit record"	Yes	Numeric; exact length per NIS standard; read-only for claimant
National Registration No.	Text Input (read-only)	Label: "National Registration Number"Format: YYMMDD-XXXXHelp: "Auto-populated from your NIS benefit record"	Yes	Pattern: YYMMDD-XXXX; read-only for claimant

Block A — Name Block ☑ Applies (Standard split — Last / First / Middle)

ℹ *The paper form collects Last Name, First Name, and Middle Name in three separate fields — consistent with the standard Name Block used across the NIS form series.*

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Last Name	Text Input	Label: "Last Name"Placeholder: "e.g., Browne"	Yes	Max 100 chars
First Name	Text Input	Label: "First Name"Placeholder: "e.g., Akira"	Yes	Max 100 chars
Middle Name(s)	Text Input	Label: "Middle Name(s)"Help: "Optional. Include all middle names."	No	Max 200 chars

Block B — Address Block ☑ Applies (Barbados Address — Standard Block)

> ℹ *The paper form captures Address, District, Parish, and Postal Code — consistent with the standard Barbados Address Block. This is now a deeply confirmed Standard Block across the NIS form series.*

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Street Address	Text Input	Label: "Address"Placeholder: "e.g., 15 Hawthorn Drive"	Yes	Max 200 chars
District	Text Input	Label: "District"Help: "Village or district name"	No	Max 100 chars
Parish	Dropdown Select	Label: "Parish"Options: Christ Church | St. Andrew | St. George | St. James | St. John | St. Joseph | St. Lucy | St. Michael | St. Peter | St. Philip | St. Thomas	Yes	Must select one
Postal Code	Text Input	Label: "Postal Code"Placeholder: "BB11000"Help: "Optional"	No	Pattern: BB[0-9]{5} (if provided)

Block C — Personal Details Block ☑ Applies (Date of Birth only)

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Date of Birth	Date Picker	Label: "Date of Birth"Format: MM/DD/YYYYPlaceholder: "mm/dd/yyyy"	Yes	Cannot be future date; must match NIS benefit record

Block D — Contact Block ☑ Applies (Tel + Cell + Email)

> ℹ *The paper form collects Tel. No., Cell No., and E-mail Address — consistent with the fuller Contact Block used on recent NIS forms. Given the age profile of Life Certificate recipients (many are elderly), the digital service should treat telephone as primary and email as optional.*

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Telephone Number	Tel Input	Label: "Tel. No."Format: XXX-XXXXHelp: "Optional"	No	Pattern: [0-9]{3}-[0-9]{4} (if provided)
Cell Number	Tel Input	Label: "Cell No."Format: XXX-XXXX	At least one of Tel/Cell	Pattern: [0-9]{3}-[0-9]{4}
Email Address	Email Input	Label: "E-mail Address"Placeholder: "yourname@example.com" Help: "Optional"	No	Valid email format; max 100 chars
Postal Code (contact)	Text Input	Label: "Postal Code BB"Note: Listed in contact	No	Pattern: BB[0-9]{5}

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
		row on paper form alongside email		

PAGE 3 — CRITERIA & ENTITLEMENT PAGE (Survivors'/Death Benefit Recipients Only)

Purpose: Captures whether a Survivors'/Death Benefit recipient has remarried or entered into cohabitation during the period since their last Life Certificate. A 'Yes' response affects continued entitlement and triggers a date capture. This page applies ONLY to claimants receiving Survivors'/Death Benefit — it must be skipped entirely for Old Age Pension and Disablement Benefit recipients.

> ⚠ *CONDITIONAL PAGE: This page only appears if the claimant's benefit type is Survivors'/Death Benefit. The digital service must identify benefit type from the NIS record (or ask the claimant on the Start Page) and conditionally display this page. Old Age Pension and Disablement Benefit recipients bypass this page entirely.*

Question	Component Type	Options	Required	Triggers Evidence?	What Is Collected
Have you remarried or cohabitated during this period?	Radio Buttons	Yes | No	Yes	Yes (if 'Yes')	Date of marriage or start of cohabitation
Date of marriage / cohabitation (if applicable)	Date Picker	MM/DD/YYYY	Conditional	—	Shown only if remarried/cohabitated = 'Yes'; cannot be future date

> ⚑ *A 'Yes' answer to the remarriage/cohabitation question may affect the claimant's continued entitlement to Survivors'/Death Benefit. The digital service must NOT automatically suspend benefit — instead, flag the response for NIS officer review and clearly inform the claimant that NIS will contact them to discuss the impact on their benefit.*

PAGE 4 — CHECK YOUR ANSWERS PAGE

Purpose: Shows the claimant a read-only summary of all information entered before the witness certification step. REQUIRED for all forms.

> ℹ *The Check Your Answers page is particularly important for this form because it precedes the witness certification step. Both the claimant and the witness should be able to review the completed claimant details before the witness counter-signs.*

Section	Fields to Display
Personal Details	NIN (read-only), NRN (read-only), Full Name, Address, Parish, Postal Code, Date of Birth, Tel. No., Cell No., Email
Benefit Type	Benefit type auto-identified from NIS record (Old Age Pension / Survivors' Benefit / Disablement Benefit)
Survivors' Benefit Declaration (if applicable)	Remarried/cohabitated: Yes/No; Date of marriage/cohabitation (if Yes)
Claimant Declaration	Confirms claimant has reviewed all information and is ready to sign

PAGE 5 — PAYMENT & SUBMIT PAGE (Two-Phase: Claimant + Witness)

No Payment Required. This page handles two sequential actions: (1) the claimant's declaration and signature/mark, and (2) the authorised witness's certification. Both must be completed before final submission.

> ⚠ *This is the most structurally complex page of this form. The claimant signs first, then hands the form (or secure digital link) to the witness. The witness must complete their certification section independently. The digital service must enforce this sequence — the witness section cannot be completed before the claimant section.*

Phase 1 — Claimant Declaration & Signature

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Declaration Statement	Static Text	Text: "I declare that the information I have provided in this Life Certificate is true and correct. I am the person named above and I am alive on the date of this declaration."Note: This is the standard declaration implied by Section A of the paper form	—	—
Claimant Signature	Signature Pad or Checkbox Declaration	Label: "Signature or Mark of Claimant"Help: "Sign using the signature pad, or if you are unable to sign, place your mark (X) below. Your mark must be witnessed."Note: Paper form explicitly allows a 'mark (X)' for claimants unable to sign	Yes	Either signature or mark required; if mark, witness must be notified
Date of Declaration	Date (auto-filled)	Label: "Date"Auto-filled with today's dateFormat: Day | Month | Year	Auto	Cannot be future date; must be within current submission window (June or December)

Phase 2 — Witness Certification (Section B)

> ℹ *Section B on the paper form is completed by the authorised witness. The digital service should provide a separate, secure entry point for the witness — either a unique link sent to the witness by the claimant, or a face-to-face in-person digital mode where the claimant hands the device to the witness.*

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Witness Name Statement	Static Text (pre-filled)	Label: "I, the undersigned, hereby certify that	—	—

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
		[CLAIMANT NAME] was alive on the date below."Note: Claimant name is pre-populated from Section A		
Date Claimant Was Seen Alive	Date Picker	Label: "Date the claimant was alive"Format: Day | Month | YearHelp: "Enter the date on which you personally confirmed the claimant was alive"	Yes	Cannot be future date; must be on or before today; should be within 30 days of submission
Witness Name (Print)	Text Input	Label: "Print Name"Placeholder: "e.g., Dr. Celeste Howard"Help: "Print your full name clearly"	Yes	Max 200 chars
Witness Signature	Signature Pad	Label: "Signature"Help: "Sign to certify that you witnessed the claimant alive on the date above"	Yes	Required; witness must sign independently from claimant
Witness Profession	Text Input or Dropdown	Label: "Profession" Options: Magistrate | Justice of the Peace | Medical Practitioner | Attorney-at-Law | Bank Manager | Member of Parliament | Senior Civil Servant | Gazetted Police Officer | Senior NIS Officer | Notary Public (overseas) | Bank Official (overseas) | Other (please specify)Help: "Select your qualifying profession"	Yes	Must be a qualifying witness category; 'Other' triggers a free-text field
Date Witness Signed	Date (auto or manual)	Label: "Date Signed"Format: MM/DD/YYYYHelp: "The date you are signing this certification"	Yes	Cannot be future date; should match or follow date claimant was seen alive
Official Stamp	File Upload or Checkbox	Label: "Official Stamp (if applicable) "Help: "If your profession requires an official stamp, upload a scan of it here, or confirm a stamped hard copy will be delivered to NIS" Accepted: PDF, JPG, PNG | Max: 5MB	Condition al	Required only for professions that carry an official stamp (e.g., Notary Public, JP, Medical Practitioner); optional for others

PAGE 6 — CONFIRMATION & NEXT STEPS PAGE

Purpose: Confirms that the Life Certificate has been successfully submitted to NIS and advises the claimant of their next submission date. REQUIRED for all forms.

Success Message	Your Life Certificate has been successfully submitted to the National Insurance Office. Your benefit payments will continue as normal.
Reference Number Format	LC-[YEAR]-[MONTH]-XXXXXXXX (e.g., LC-2026-06-00001234)
Expected Timeline	NIS will process your Life Certificate within 5 working days. You will be notified if there are any issues with your submission.
Next Submission Due	Your next Life Certificate is due in [June / December] [year]. NIS will send you a reminder closer to the due date.
Survivors' Benefit Flag (if applicable)	If you declared a change in marital or cohabitation status, an NIS officer will contact you within 10 working days to discuss the impact on your benefit.
If Changes Needed	If you need to correct information in this submission, contact the NIS office as soon as possible at the details below.
Contact Information	National Insurance Office Culloden Road, St. Michael, Barbados, West IndiesTelephone: (246) 431-7400 | Website: www.nisbb.gov.bb

CONDITIONAL LOGIC

Document all IF/THEN rules that control what pages appear, what fields are shown, and what actions occur based on claimant or witness responses.

Condition (IF)	Action (THEN)
IF benefit type = 'Survivors'/Death Benefit'	THEN show Criteria & Entitlement Page (Page 3) — remarriage/cohabitation check. Skip this page for all other benefit types.
IF remarried/cohabitated = 'Yes'	THEN show 'Date of marriage/cohabitation' date picker field AND display inline notice: 'NIS will contact you to discuss the impact on your benefit. Your payments will continue while this is being reviewed.'
IF remarried/cohabitated = 'No'	THEN hide date field; proceed to Check Your Answers
IF claimant signs with 'mark (X)' instead of signature	THEN display witness notice: 'The claimant has indicated they are unable to sign. Their mark (X) must be witnessed. Please confirm you have witnessed the claimant place their mark.' Require witness confirmation checkbox.
IF witness profession = 'Other'	THEN show free-text field: 'Please describe your profession or qualifying role' (max 200 chars)
IF witness profession is overseas category (Notary Public, Barbados Mission, Bank Official)	THEN display notice: 'For overseas submissions, please ensure a stamped and certified hard copy is also sent to the NIS office.'
IF current date is outside June or December submission window	THEN display advisory: 'Life Certificates are due in June and December. You are submitting outside the standard window — your certificate will still be accepted, but please contact NIS if you have concerns about your payment.'
IF date claimant was seen alive is more than 30 days before submission date	THEN display validation warning: 'The date the claimant was seen alive is more than 30 days ago. Please confirm this is correct before proceeding.' Allow override with confirmation checkbox.

EMERGING PATTERNS & REUSABLE BLOCKS

ℹ *This section tracks patterns appearing across multiple forms. Document here for identification and eventual promotion to Standard Blocks when seen in 3+ forms.*

Witness / Third-Party Certifier Block — NEW EMERGING PATTERN

⚠ *First occurrence in this form series of a Witness Certification block — a third party who is neither the applicant nor an institutional officer, but an individual authorising the claimant's declaration. Monitor for reuse: if this pattern appears in 2+ additional forms, promote to Standard Block.*

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Witness Name (Print)	Text Input	Label: "Print Name"	Yes	Max 200 chars
Witness Signature	Signature Pad	Label: "Signature"	Yes	Required before submission
Profession / Role	Dropdown + conditional free-text	Label: "Profession" Options: Qualifying categories list If 'Other': free-text field	Yes	Must be qualifying category; 'Other' triggers free-text
Date Signed	Date (auto or manual)	Label: "Date Signed"Format: MM/DD/YYYY	Yes	Cannot be future date
Official Stamp	File Upload or Declaration Checkbox	Label: "Official Stamp (if applicable)"	Conditional	Required for stamp-carrying professions

Proof of Life / Periodic Renewal Block — NEW EMERGING PATTERN

ℹ *First occurrence of a proof-of-life renewal pattern. The bi-annual submission cadence and date-of-witnessing fields are unique to this form. If annual or periodic renewal forms appear elsewhere in the NIS series, consider standardising this block.*

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Date Claimant Was Seen Alive	Date Picker	Label: "Date the claimant was alive"Format: MM/DD/YYYYHelp: "Date you personally confirmed the claimant was alive"	Yes	Cannot be future date; within 30 days of submission
Submission Period	Auto / Derived	Label: "Submission Period"Auto-derived: June or December based on current date	Auto	Used to validate submission window and set next due date
Next Due Date	Auto / Derived	Label: "Next Life Certificate Due"Auto-calculated: 6 months after submission	Auto	Displayed on Confirmation page and in NIS notification

Marital / Cohabitation Status Block — CONDITIONAL — Survivors' Benefit Only

> ℹ *This pattern currently appears only in the Survivors'/Death Benefit section of the Life Certificate. If other benefit forms require marital status checks (e.g., dependency benefit applications), this block may be promoted.*

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Remarried / Cohabitated	Radio Buttons	Label: "Have you remarried or cohabitated during this period?" Options: Yes | No	Yes (conditional page)	If 'Yes': show date field and NIS review notice
Date of Change	Date Picker	Label: "Date of marriage / cohabitation" Format: MM/DD/YYYY	Conditional (if Yes)	Cannot be future date; must be within reporting period

DECLARATION BLOCK

This form has two distinct declaration sub-blocks: one for the claimant and one for the authorised witness. Both are required before submission.

Claimant Declaration

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Declaration Statement	Static Text	Text: "I declare that the information provided in this Life Certificate is true and correct. I am the person named above and I am alive on the date of this declaration."	—	—
Consent Checkboxes	Checkbox(es)	☐ I confirm all personal details shown are correct ☐ I understand that providing false information is an offence under the National Insurance and Social Security Act, Cap. 47	Yes (all)	All checkboxes must be checked before signature step is enabled
Signature or Mark	Signature Pad	Label: "Signature or Mark of Claimant" Help: "In case you are unable to sign, place your mark (X). Your mark must be witnessed."	Yes	Signature or mark required
Date	Date (auto)	Auto-filled with current date	Auto	Cannot be future date

Witness Declaration (Section B)

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Witness Certification Statement	Static Text	Text: "I, the undersigned, hereby certify that [CLAIMANT NAME], whose signature is affixed above, was alive on the date recorded below."	—	—
Consent / Attestation Checkbox	Checkbox	☐ I confirm I am not a family member of the claimant ☐ I confirm I have personally verified the claimant's identity using a valid ID document ☐ I understand that providing a false certification is an offence punishable by fine or imprisonment	Yes (all)	All checkboxes must be checked before witness can sign

Field Name	Component	Label / Help Text	Required	Validation
Witness Signature	Signature Pad	Label: "Signature"	Yes	Required; must be completed after claimant signature
Date Signed	Date (auto or manual)	Label: "Date Signed"Format: MM/DD/YYYY	Yes	Cannot be future date
Submit Button	Button (Primary)	Label: "Submit Life Certificate" Colour: Green	—	Enabled only after both claimant and witness sections are complete

NOTES & EDGE CASES

Note 1 — Accessibility & Age Profile

Many Life Certificate recipients are elderly or have disabilities (the form applies to Disablement Benefit recipients). The digital service must prioritise accessibility: large text options, screen reader compatibility, telephone-based fallback, and support for witnesses completing the form on behalf of or alongside the claimant. The 'mark (X)' provision in the paper form must be preserved digitally.

Note 2 — Overseas Recipients

The paper form instructions specify different witness categories for overseas beneficiaries. The digital service must ask whether the claimant is resident in Barbados or overseas on the Start Page, and display the appropriate witness category list. For overseas submissions, a stamped physical copy requirement may apply.

Note 3 — Witness Sequencing in a Digital Flow

The paper form allows the claimant and witness to complete the form together in person. In the digital service, two models should be supported: (a) In-person digital: claimant and witness complete the form on the same device sequentially; (b) Remote digital: claimant completes their section and sends a secure witness link to an authorised person. The second model introduces identity verification challenges — NIS policy input is required.

Note 4 — Pre-population from NIS Records

NIN, NRN, and personal details should be pre-populated from the NIS benefit record. This is critical for elderly and disabled claimants who may struggle with data entry. The claimant should review and confirm, not re-enter, their details.

Note 5 — Submission Window Validation

The form is due in June and December. The digital service should send proactive reminders to claimants in advance of each window. Submissions outside the window should be accepted but flagged — the service must not hard-block late submissions, as some claimants may face genuine difficulties with timing.

Note 6 — Survivors' Benefit Entitlement Impact

The remarriage/cohabitation disclosure in Section A (Survivors' Benefit variant) has significant benefit implications. The digital service must NOT auto-suspend benefit upon a 'Yes' response — this decision must be made by an NIS officer. The claimant must be clearly informed that NIS will review their case and that payments will continue during the review period.

Note 7 — Mark (X) and Witnessed Signatures

The paper form explicitly allows a claimant to place a 'mark (X)' if unable to sign. This must be accommodated in the digital service — either through an accessible signature mechanism or a witnessed declaration option where the witness confirms the claimant placed their mark. This is legally and ethically important for claimants with physical disabilities.

FORM COMPLEXITY ASSESSMENT

Rating	Why this form is rated Medium
MEDIUM	Although the form is short (~22 fields), it carries significant complexity in its digital translation: dual user roles (claimant + witness), a conditional page for Survivors' Benefit recipients, a multi-phase submit flow with sequencing constraints, and critical accessibility requirements for an elderly/disabled audience. The periodic renewal cadence and overseas variant also add design complexity.

	Complexity Signals
☑	Single applicant — Yes (single claimant), but requires separate witness role
☒	Looping blocks — Not present
☑	Conditional logic — 1–2 levels (benefit type branch; remarriage/cohabitation date)
☑	Branching by applicant type — Yes: Survivors' Benefit vs Old Age Pension vs Disablement Benefit
☑	File uploads — Official stamp upload (conditional; witness role)
☒	Payment integration — Not required
☑	Multi-party signatures — Yes: claimant signature/mark + witness signature (sequential)
☒	Multi-MDA routing — Not required
☒	Professional vouching — Witness certification (not exactly vouching, but close)
☒	Technical specifications — Not required

Total Fields	~22 fields across 2 sections plus two declaration sub-blocks
Total Sections / Pages	6 pages (Start, Claimant Details, Criteria & Entitlement [conditional], Check Answers, Submit [two-phase], Confirmation)
Conditional Logic Depth	2 levels: benefit type branch → remarriage/cohabitation date field